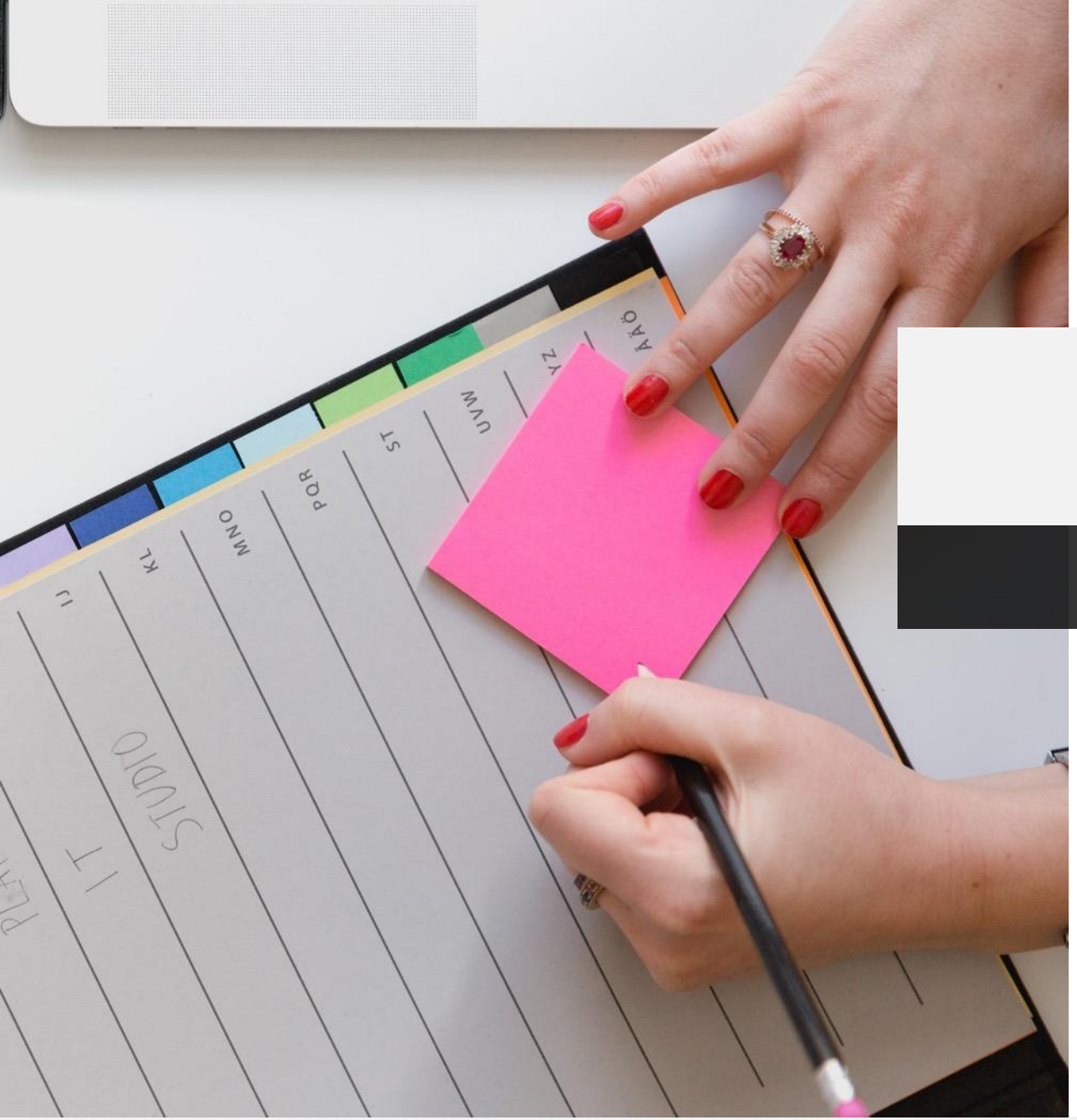


Entrepreneurship in Pharmacy

Dr Mai Abdelhadi
mai.abdelhadi@pharm.aun.edu.eg
Dept. of Pharmacognosy



Definitions and Concepts

What is Entrepreneurship?

- The process of designing, launching, and running a new business, which often begins as a small business, but has the potential for growth.

- It involves identifying a business opportunity, gathering resources, and taking calculated risks to make a profit.

What is Entrepreneur?

An entrepreneur is a person who identifies a business opportunity, takes the initiative to organize and manage resources, and assumes the risks involved in starting and running a business.

Entrepreneurs are often characterized by their innovation, creativity, and willingness to take calculated risks to achieve their goals. Their efforts may result in the development of new products, services, or markets.

Key Characteristics of Entrepreneurs

Innovation: They are creative and come up with new ideas, products, or services.

Risk-taking: They are willing to take calculated risks to achieve their goals.

Passion: They are driven by a strong desire to succeed and make a difference.

Key Characteristics of Entrepreneurs

Leadership: They are effective leaders who can motivate and inspire others.

Problem-solving: They can identify and solve problems effectively.

Resilience: They can bounce back from setbacks and learn from their mistakes.

Core Elements of Entrepreneurial Success

- Opportunity Identification – Recognizing market needs and creating business ideas.
- Business Planning – Developing a clear vision, mission, and business model.
- Risk Management – Assessing and minimizing potential business risks.
- Financial Management – Budgeting, securing funding, and managing cash flow.
- Marketing & Sales – Promoting products/services and attracting customers.

Core Elements of Entrepreneurial Success

- Innovation & Problem-Solving – Continuously improving products and services.
- Leadership & Team Management – Leading employees and building a strong team.
- Customer Relationship Management – Providing excellent service and retaining customers.

Core Elements of Entrepreneurial Success

- Adaptability – Responding to market changes and staying competitive.
- Sustainability & Ethics – Running a responsible and long-term business.
- Networking and Relationship Building – Connecting with mentors, investors, and partners. Building a strong support system.
- Continuous Learning and Growth Mindset – Staying updated with industry trends. Embracing lifelong learning and skill development.

Challenges in Entrepreneurship Development

Financial Constraints: Limited access to capital and funding sources.

Market Competition: Established businesses create barriers for startups.

Regulatory and Legal Barriers: Complex business laws and high tax rates can discourage entrepreneurship.

Risk of Failure: Many startups fail due to poor planning, lack of market demand, or operational inefficiencies.

Technological Disruptions: Rapid technological changes require continuous adaptation.

The Future of Entrepreneurship

It is driven by digitalization, sustainability, and globalization.

Emerging trends include:

Green Entrepreneurship: Focus on eco-friendly and sustainable business practices.

Social Entrepreneurship: Businesses that address social and environmental issues.

Artificial Intelligence and Automation: Use of AI to improve efficiency and innovation.

Remote Work and Digital Businesses: Growth of e-commerce, freelancing, and online services.

Terms of Entrepreneurship



Core Terms

Entrepreneur: An individual who starts and runs a business, assuming financial and operational risks.

Startup: A newly established business, often focused on innovation and rapid growth.

Innovation: The process of developing new products, services, processes, or business models to meet market needs.

Core Terms

Business Model: A plan outlining how a company creates, delivers, and earns value.

Market Research: The process of gathering information about target customers and market trends.

Value Proposition: The unique benefit a business offers to its customers.

Financial Terms

Revenue: The income a business earns from its operations.

Profit Margin: The percentage of revenue that exceeds costs and expenses.

Capital: Financial resources needed to start and operate a business.

Financial Terms

Bootstrapping (self-funding): Starting a business with minimal external funding, relying instead on personal savings or revenue.

Venture Capital: Investment provided by firms or individuals to startups with high growth potential.

Strategic Terms

Minimum Viable Product: A basic version of a product with enough features to attract early adopters and validate a concept.

Scalability: The ability of a business to grow and expand efficiently.

Pivot: A strategic shift in a company's business model or product direction based on market feedback, while keeping its core vision.

Legal and Operational Terms

Intellectual Property: Legal rights to inventions, designs, trademarks, and creative works.

Equity: Ownership interest in a company, often distributed as shares.

Partnership: A business owned and managed by two or more individuals.

Franchise: A business model where one party licenses its operations, brand, and expertise to another.

Market and Customer Terms

Target Audience: The specific group of people a business aims to serve.

Customer Acquisition Cost: The cost of gaining a new customer.

Customer Lifetime Value: The total revenue a business expects to earn from a single customer.

Risk and Performance Terms

Risk Management: Identifying, assessing, and addressing potential risks to a business.

Key Performance Indicators: Metrics used to evaluate the success of a business's activities.

Break-Even Point: The point at which a business's revenue equals its costs, leading to no profit or loss.

Questions



MCQ

Fill in the spaces

Write the scientific term

Match

Case study

Introduction:

Yousef, a recent horticulture graduate, dreamed of making gardening accessible to city dwellers with limited space. He envisioned a subscription box service delivering curated sets of plants, soil, and tools, along with expert guidance, directly to people's doorsteps. He called his venture "Bloom Boxes."

Challenges:

- Initial Rejection: Yousef presented his idea to several investors, but all initially rejected him. They cited concerns about the perishability of plants and the logistics of delivery.

- Logistical Nightmares: Yousef's first few deliveries arrived damaged due to rough handling in transit, and some subscribers complained about incorrect or missing items. He was overwhelmed with customer service issues.

- Market Shift: Just as Yousef began to find his footing, a larger, well-funded competitor entered the market with a similar, but slightly different, subscription box model. This new competitor offered lower prices and a wider variety of plants.

Yousef's Actions

1. Despite the initial rejections, Yousef refused to give up. He used the feedback he received to refine his business plan, focusing on addressing the investors' concerns. He researched packaging methods to ensure plant safety during shipping and developed a more detailed financial projection.
2. Yousef realized he needed to differentiate Bloom Boxes from the competition. He introduced several new features: themed boxes (e.g., "Herb Garden," "Succulent Collection"), personalized plant recommendations based on subscriber surveys. He also explored partnerships with local nurseries to source unique and rare plants.

Yousef's Actions

3. When faced with the logistical problems, he didn't get discouraged. He personally contacted each affected customer, apologized, and offered replacements or refunds. Then he analyzed the delivery process, identified weak points, and implemented changes, including partnering with a more reliable courier service and implementing a stricter quality control system before shipping.

Yousef's Actions

4. Seeing the new competitor enter the market, Yousef didn't panic. Instead, he saw it as an opportunity. He analyzed their model, identified their weaknesses (less personalized service, limited plant variety), and doubled down on Bloom Boxes' strengths. He also introduced a "Build Your Own Box" option, allowing subscribers to customize their plant selections.

Question

Analyze Yousef’s actions and mention the key entrepreneurial skills that helped him overcome the challenges he faced.

Resilience **Innovation** **Problem-solving**